

# Qilu (Lisa) Pan

Mitchell E. Daniels, Jr. School of Business  
Department of Economics, Purdue University  
403 Mitch Daniels Blvd, West Lafayette, IN 47907

Phone: +1(765)-701-3040  
Email: [pan278@purdue.edu](mailto:pan278@purdue.edu)  
Web: <https://lisapan.org/>

## EDUCATION

---

- |                                                                      |                                                                   |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Purdue University, Mitchell E. Daniels, Jr. School of Business       | West Lafayette, IN                                                |
| ◦ Ph.D. in Economics                                                 | 2020 - May 2027 (Expected; able to graduate earlier upon request) |
| Committee: Victoria Prowse (Chair), Kevin Mumford, Tim Bond, Ben Zou |                                                                   |
| ◦ M.S. in Economics                                                  | 2022                                                              |
| Purdue University, Mitchell E. Daniels, Jr. School of Business       | West Lafayette, IN                                                |
| ◦ B.S. in Economics                                                  | 2018-2020                                                         |
| Minors in Mathematics and Statistics                                 |                                                                   |
| China Agricultural University                                        | Beijing, China                                                    |
| ◦ B.A. in Economics                                                  | 2016 - 2020                                                       |

## RESEARCH INTERESTS

---

Public Economics, Labor Economics, Health Economics, and Economics of Education

## PEER-REVIEWED PUBLICATIONS

---

- [1] The Impact of Minimum Wage on Intra-Household Decision-Making: Evidence from Japan. *Social Indicators Research*. [link](#)

**Abstract:** This paper examines how increases in wives' market value, measured through wages, shape intra-household tradeoffs in Japan. Using a Difference-in-Differences strategy, I exploit minimum wage hikes to study their effects on wives' relative income and time allocation. Evidence from the Japanese Household Panel Survey shows that higher minimum wages reduce the gender wage gap by encouraging wives—particularly those with young children—to enter the labor force and extend their working hours. Wives without young children respond by increasing employment while reducing time devoted to home production, whereas those with young children primarily adjust by sacrificing leisure. By contrast, husbands exhibit limited responses to wage changes. These findings highlight that narrowing the gender wage gap, while promoting women's labor market participation, can also intensify their household burden. The results underscore the need for policies that address not only income disparities but also inequalities in unpaid work and time use within households.

## WORKING PAPERS

---

- [1] **Labor Supply under Nonlinear Tax Programs: Evidence from the Interaction of EITC and Wage Shocks.** *Job Market Paper*

**Abstract:** Does the Earned Income Tax Credit cushion local labor markets from wage shocks? I show that the answer depends on where a shock lands on the credit's schedule. In the phase-out, a smaller credit offsets part of any wage gain, so greater generosity should reduce the employment response; in the phase-in, the credit adds to each dollar earned, so it should amplify the response. I test this using the uneven 1993–1996 EITC expansion across commuting zones, measured with predetermined family-size shares, and two wage shocks that hit different parts of the earnings distribution: local economic booms and Chinese import competition. A \$100 higher maximum credit lowers single women's employment response to a 1% local wage gain by 0.075

percentage points and raises less-educated women's employment loss from \$1,000 of Chinese imports per worker by 0.8 percentage points. The effects are concentrated in the education groups whose position on the schedule the theory points to, and no such pattern appears in the 1980s, before the credit varied with family size. The results imply that nonlinear transfers can amplify local shocks, not only cushion them.

- [2] When Income Support Hurts and Helps: Health Effects of Survivors Benefits (with Hao Li). *Reject and Resubmit, Journal of Health Economics*

**Abstract:** We study how income support after widowhood affects health in the short and long run, using Social Security Survivors Benefits as our setting. Exploiting the age-60 eligibility threshold, we use a fuzzy regression discontinuity design and data from the Health and Retirement Study to show that benefit eligibility lowers self-reported health and increases diagnosed heart disease and diabetes. We find little evidence of changes in health behaviors or food spending. Instead, eligibility increases out-of-pocket medical spending and prescription drug use, consistent with benefits relaxing liquidity constraints on medical care and bringing previously undiagnosed conditions to clinical attention. We then exploit the 1965 reform that lowered the earliest eligibility age for reduced widow benefits from 62 to 60. Survival to age 70 increased more rapidly among birth cohorts more exposed to the reform, with no comparable pattern in Canada, while all-cause mortality declined more steeply in states with larger widow populations. Taken together, the short-run rise in diagnosed illness is consistent with greater detection through expanded access to care, and greater exposure to benefits is associated with improved survival in the long run.

- [3] Import Competition and the Redistribution of Employment Across Skill Groups in U.S. Local Labor Markets (with Victoria Prowse).

**Abstract:** Over the past several decades, import competition has reshaped employment in advanced economies. Initial waves of manufacturing imports displaced large numbers of less-educated workers. More recently, the rise of high-skill-intensive imports has raised concerns about the vulnerability of educated labor. The labor market consequences of globalization thus depend not only on the overall scale of imports but also on the skill composition of traded goods and the ability of local labor markets to transmit and amplify these shocks. This paper revisits the "China shock" through a new lens by distinguishing between local exposure to low-skill-intensive and high-skill-intensive imports. Even when direct employment losses in manufacturing are comparable, broader adjustments diverge: some local economies absorb displaced workers into non-manufacturing industries, while others experience persistently weaker re-employment prospects. Patterns of adjustment also vary across demographic groups and skill levels, underscoring the role of both worker characteristics and local task requirements in shaping outcomes. By highlighting these composition effects within import shocks, the analysis reconciles mixed evidence on regional recovery and underscores the importance of sector-specific retraining and placement policies.

- [4] Friction, Sorting, and Stratification: Evidence from Common Application Adoption (with Kevin Mumford).

**Abstract:** Reducing application frictions reshapes student-college sorting, with effects that differ sharply across the quality distribution. Exploiting staggered adoption of the Common Application across more than 2,000 four-year institutions from 2002–2019, I find that reducing application costs shifts students toward highly selective institutions while disadvantaging medium-selective schools. Most-selective institutions experience substantial enrollment and entering-class quality gains, whereas medium-selective schools experience persistent enrollment losses and widening quality gaps. Least-selective schools initially attract higher-ability students as safeties. A Bartik shift-share design based on predetermined origin-state enrollment shares confirms the enrollment effects. College Scorecard earnings data are consistent with these sorting patterns. The results suggest that reducing application frictions generates a sorting cascade that concentrates

talent at elite institutions and contributes to the decline in college enrollment at less-selective schools.

## WORKING IN PROGRESS

---

[1] The Tiger Neighbor Effect (With Kevin Mumford and Ben Zou).

## CONFERENCE TALKS

---

|                                                                  |             |
|------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------|
| SEA 95th Annual Meeting, Tampa, FL                               | Fall 2025   |
| 118th Annual Conference on Taxation, Boston, MA                  | Fall 2025   |
| International Conference on Empirical Economics, PSU-Altoona, PA | Summer 2025 |
| SEA 93rd Annual Meeting, New Orleans, LA                         | Fall 2023   |
| Chinese Economists Society Annual Conference, China              | Summer 2023 |

## HONORS AND AWARDS

---

|                                                                  |             |
|------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------|
| National Tax Association Fiscal Sustainability Travel Fellowship | Fall 2025   |
| Krannert Doctoral Student Research Fund                          | Fall 2024   |
| Krannert Certificate for Distinguished Teaching                  | Summer 2023 |
| Frederick N. Andrews Fellowship                                  | 2020-2025   |
| Jinlongyu College Scholar (Top 1%)                               | 2017        |

## TEACHING EXPERIENCE

---

### Instructor

- |                                                   |             |
|---------------------------------------------------|-------------|
| ◦ Principles of Economics ECON210 (undergraduate) | Summer 2025 |
| class size: 36; teaching evaluation: 4.16/5       |             |
| ◦ Microeconomics ECON251 (undergraduate)          | Summer 2023 |
| class size: 74; teaching evaluation: 4.51/5       |             |

### Review Session Instructor

- |                                   |             |
|-----------------------------------|-------------|
| ◦ Labor Economics (undergraduate) | Spring 2024 |
|-----------------------------------|-------------|

## PROFESSIONAL SERVICE

---

|                                                                  |                    |
|------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------|
| Referee for <i>Journal of Economic Behavior and Organization</i> |                    |
| Panelist on Job Market Mock Interviews                           | Fall 2024          |
| Labor Lunch Organizer for Department                             | Fall & Spring 2022 |
| Business Doctoral Student Association Treasurer                  | Fall & Spring 2022 |

## SKILLS

---

Programming: Stata, Python, R, Matlab, Mathematica, L<sup>A</sup>T<sub>E</sub>X

## REFERENCES

---

Victoria Prowse  
Professor of Economics and Marge Magner Chair  
Daniels School of Business  
Purdue University  
Email: [vprowse@purdue.edu](mailto:vprowse@purdue.edu)

Timothy Bond  
Professor of Economics  
Daniels School of Business  
Purdue University  
Email: [tnbond@purdue.edu](mailto:tnbond@purdue.edu)

Kevin Mumford  
Professor of Economics  
Daniels School of Business  
Purdue University  
Email: [mumford@purdue.edu](mailto:mumford@purdue.edu)

Ben Zou  
Associate Professor of Economics  
Daniels School of Business  
Purdue University  
Email: [zou136@purdue.edu](mailto:zou136@purdue.edu)